Notable User Manual

A visual guide to filing research documents and reading, finding and exporting PDF annotations.

For Notable 2.5.0 on Windows

Use the local PDF workflow first. Add one familiar folder, let Notable collect its annotations, then read a note and open its source page. Sorting and reMarkable syncing can be set up separately.

If you want to	Start with
Read notes from PDFs you already have	Library → Add folder → select a paper → View notes
Name and file new documents	Inbox → Set up Inbox → Add documents → Review selected
Write with your collected notes	Notes → Open notebook; use Actions → Save editable copy for your own writing
Bring in tablet annotations	Settings → Connections; then pair and choose a limited reMarkable folder

How to use the pictures Colored outlines mark controls. Numbered circles and arrows match the instructions on the same page. Cropped screenshots focus on the relevant controls; zoom in your PDF viewer for a closer look.

Screens show example papers from the current interface audit. Folder paths are masked. Empty lists and disabled buttons are shown as captured; the instructions explain what makes those controls available.

Find the task you need

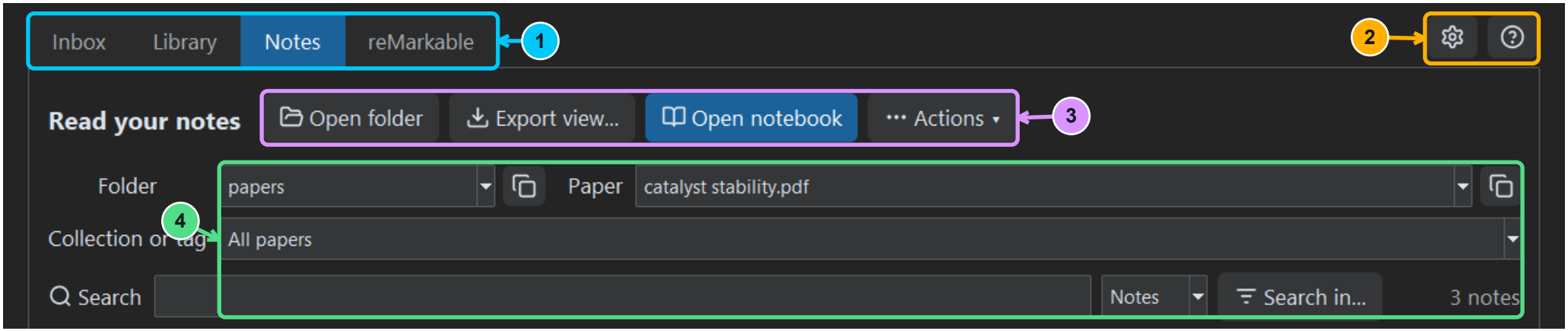
Choose a topic below. Each entry is clickable, and the PDF bookmark pane provides the same navigation.

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Remember: The reMarkable tab is hidden in a new library until you enable it in Settings → Connections.

Find your way around

The tabs separate incoming documents, watched folders, saved notes and optional tablet syncing.



1 **Choose a workspace.** Inbox files incoming documents. Library watches existing PDF folders. Notes reads saved annotations. reMarkable handles cloud work.

2 **Open Settings or Help.** The gear opens Settings; the question mark opens in-app Help. Hover over icons for their labels.

3 **Use the task toolbar.** Primary actions stay visible. Actions opens additional commands for the current workspace or paper.

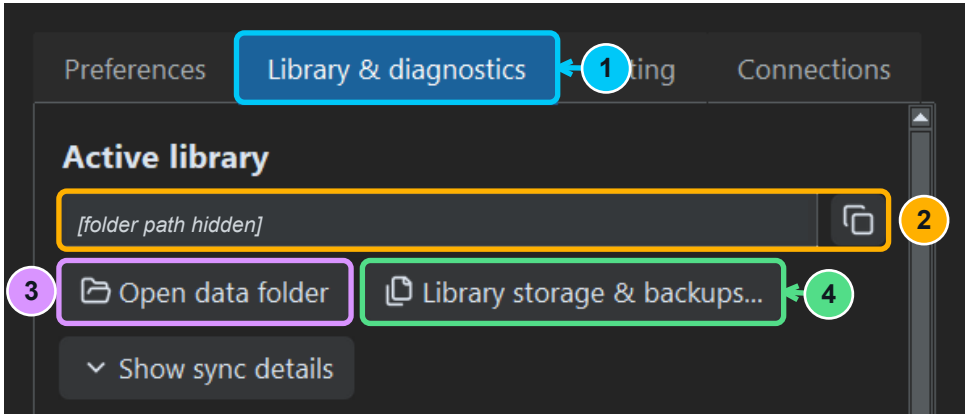
4 **Choose the scope.** In Notes, choose a folder and paper before searching or exporting. All folders and All papers widen the view.

Long paths and tables Hover over paths to see their complete value. The adjacent copy icon copies the full path. Drag a column divider to resize it; double-click to fit current rows. Drag pane dividers to give the note list or preview more room.

Remember: Local PDF watching, automatic Inbox checks and cloud checks run while Notable is open. There is no separate background service.

Open the app and check your library

The saved library holds settings, notes, history and retained tablet sources. Your paper folders hold your research files.



Launch the current source app

Run **Run PDF Note Organizer.ps1** from the project folder. In VS Code, choose **Notable - development library** in Run and Debug and press F5. The older executable in dist belongs to a previous release.

If you run the source directly, use the project environment: **.venv\Scripts\python.exe "PDF Note Organizer.py"**

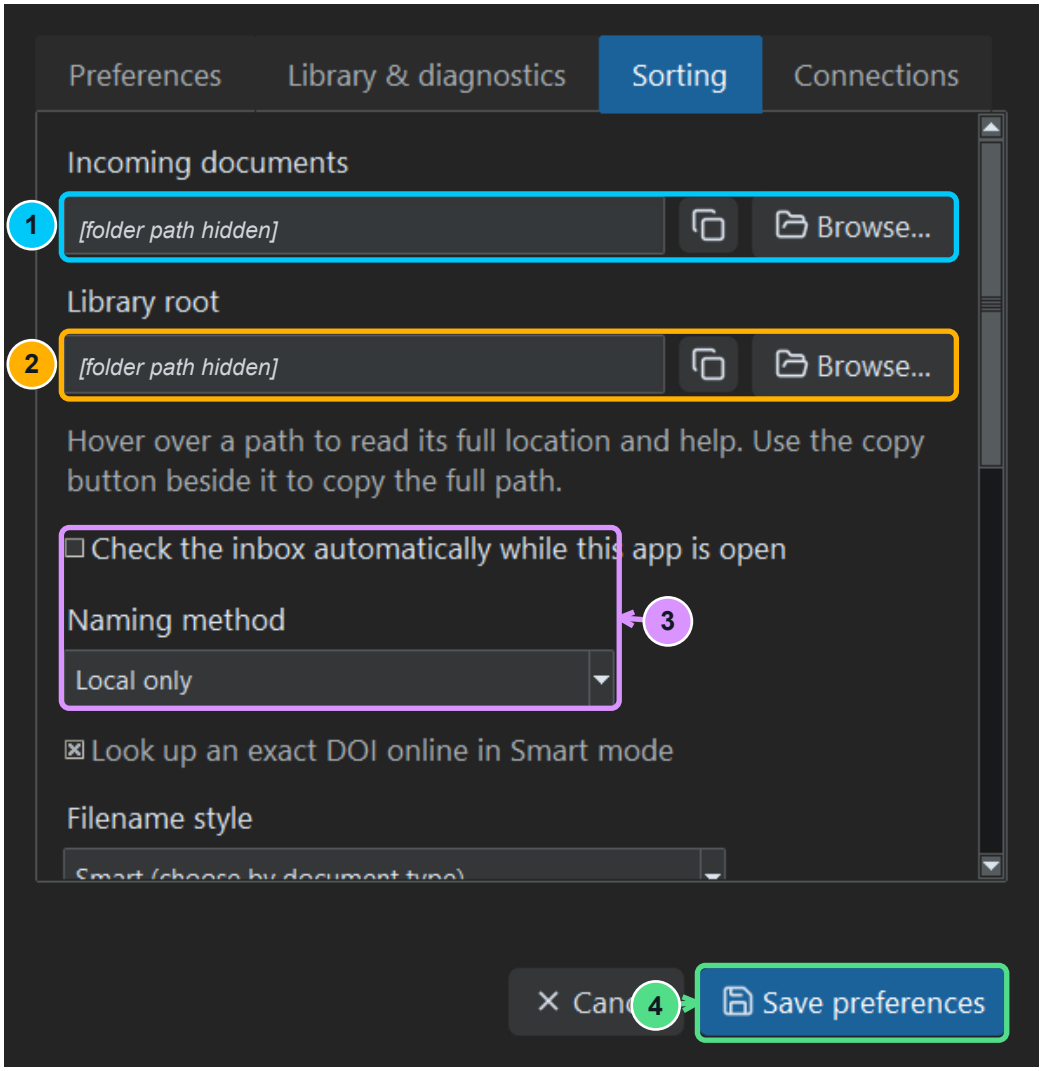
For first installation, follow the setup commands in the project README. The project uses Python 3.13 and requirements.lock for its tested Windows environment.

1. **Open diagnostics.** Choose the gear → Library & diagnostics.
2. **Check Active library.** The source app normally uses .local-data beside the app. An explicit PDF_NOTES_DATA_DIR selects a different library.
3. **Inspect saved data.** Open data folder shows the actual location in File Explorer. Copying just library.sqlite3 misses retained tablet files.
4. **Find maintenance.** Library storage & backups opens backup and restore tools. It does not merge separately saved libraries.

Remember: Keep the app data directory separate from the incoming folder and your ordinary research folders.

Set up the sorting folders

Open Inbox → Set up Inbox, or Settings → Sorting. You can leave sorting unconfigured when you only want PDF notes.



1. **Choose Incoming documents.**
   Use a dedicated folder for files awaiting review. New downloads are scanned directly inside it, rather than in its subfolders.

2. **Choose Library root.**
   This is the parent folder for filed documents. The incoming folder and root must be separate, with neither inside the other. Both must exist for automatic checks.

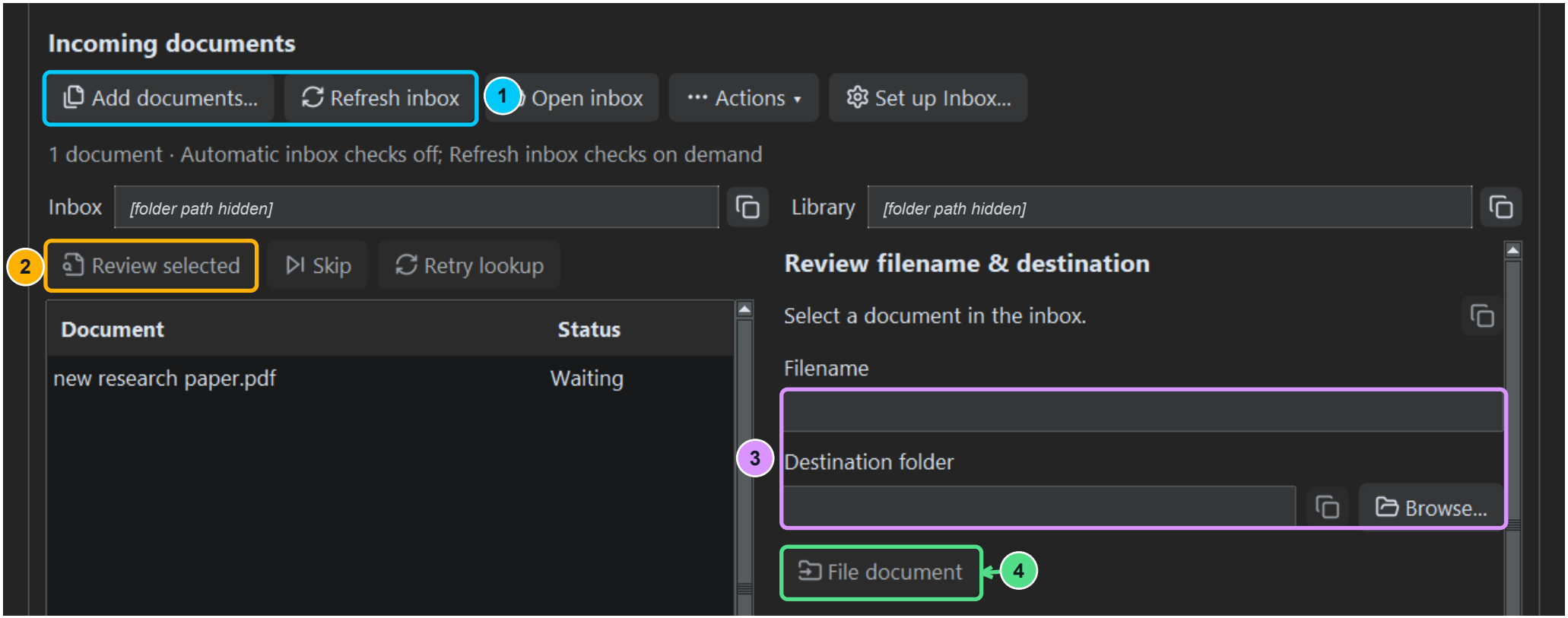
3. **Choose how names are found.**
   Local only uses local text and metadata. Smart can use permitted DOI lookup and optional Gemini identification. Automatic checking works while the app is open.

4. **Save the draft.**
   Save preferences commits all Settings tabs. Cancel or Escape discards the draft. Scroll the form for filename style, custom naming and optional service settings.

Remember: A DOI lookup sends the identifier. Optional Gemini can send extracted document text and requires its own key and permissions; DOCX and PPTX each have separate permissions.

Review and file an incoming document

Supported sorting formats are PDF, DOCX, PPTX and legacy PPT. Only PDFs enter the note extraction workflow.



1 **Add and refresh.** Add documents copies selected files into Inbox and keeps the external source. Drag-and-drop works too. Let downloads stop changing, then Refresh inbox.

2 **Review the ready file.** Select its row and choose Review selected. The example still says Waiting, so review and filing are disabled until it is ready.

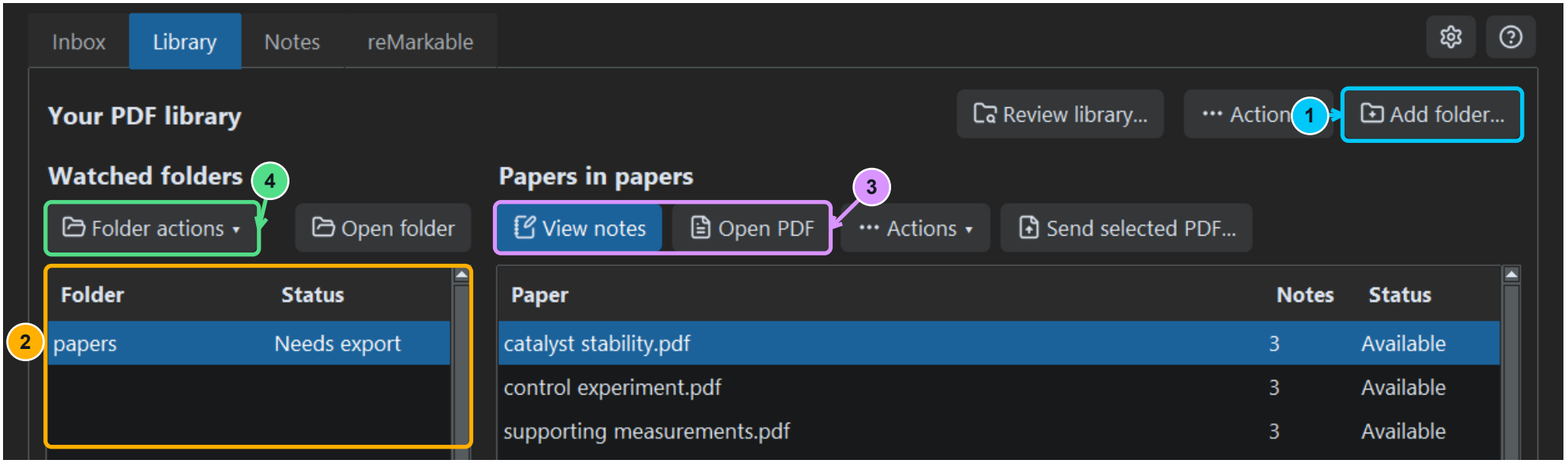
3 **Check the proposed result.** Review title, authors, year and any explanation. Edit the filename; keep the source extension. Choose a folder beneath Library root.

4 **File and confirm.** Read the final name and destination. Filing verifies the copy before removing the Inbox source. A collision leaves both existing files intact.

Remember: Skip leaves the file in place. Retry lookup keeps an edited filename. If a source changes, review it again. Actions → Filing recovery shows unresolved copies.

Watch an existing PDF folder

Add existing research folders in Library. You do not need to send an established collection through Inbox.



1 **Add folder.** Choose an existing folder. Notable scans PDFs recursively and reads their annotations without editing the originals. Start with a small, familiar folder.

2 **Select the watched folder.** Each folder has its own processing settings and generated Word notebook. Non-overlapping folders make the starting library easier to understand.

3 **Choose a paper.** View notes or double-click its row to read annotations. Open PDF prepares a reading view with verified PC and tablet marks when available.

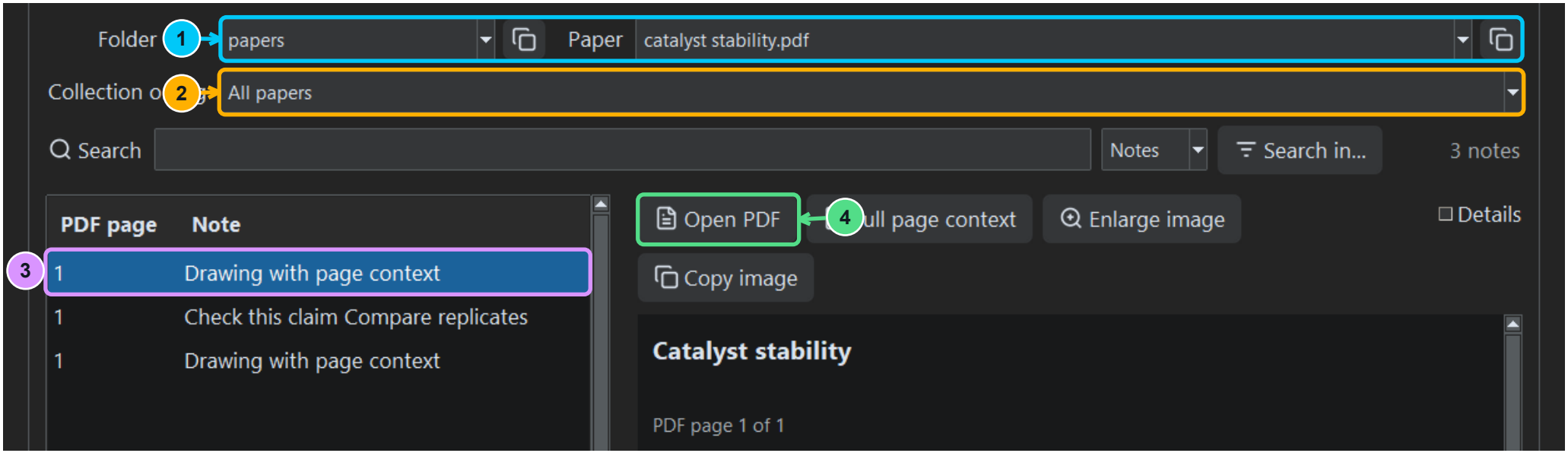
4 **Manage the folder.** Folder actions offers folder settings and notebook commands. If a folder moved, use Locate moved folder on its existing entry to keep its history.

Refresh and inspect Sync PDFs at the bottom right checks local watched folders now. Show sync details expands the processing log. These local checks are separate from Sync PDFs on the reMarkable tab.

Remember: Remove folder removes that project's saved library and history after confirmation. Its PDFs and Word notebooks stay on disk.

Read and filter notes

Choose a paper, then select an annotation in the result list. The preview shows its text, source page and any retained image.



1 **Set the folder and paper.** All folders and All papers broaden the result set. Copy icons beside the selections copy the relevant full source path.

2 **Narrow the collection.** Choose a tag or research collection, or leave All papers selected. Search further narrows the current scope.

3 **Read a result.** Select a note to view it. Drawings and handwriting include context images; highlights and typed comments use text and source links.

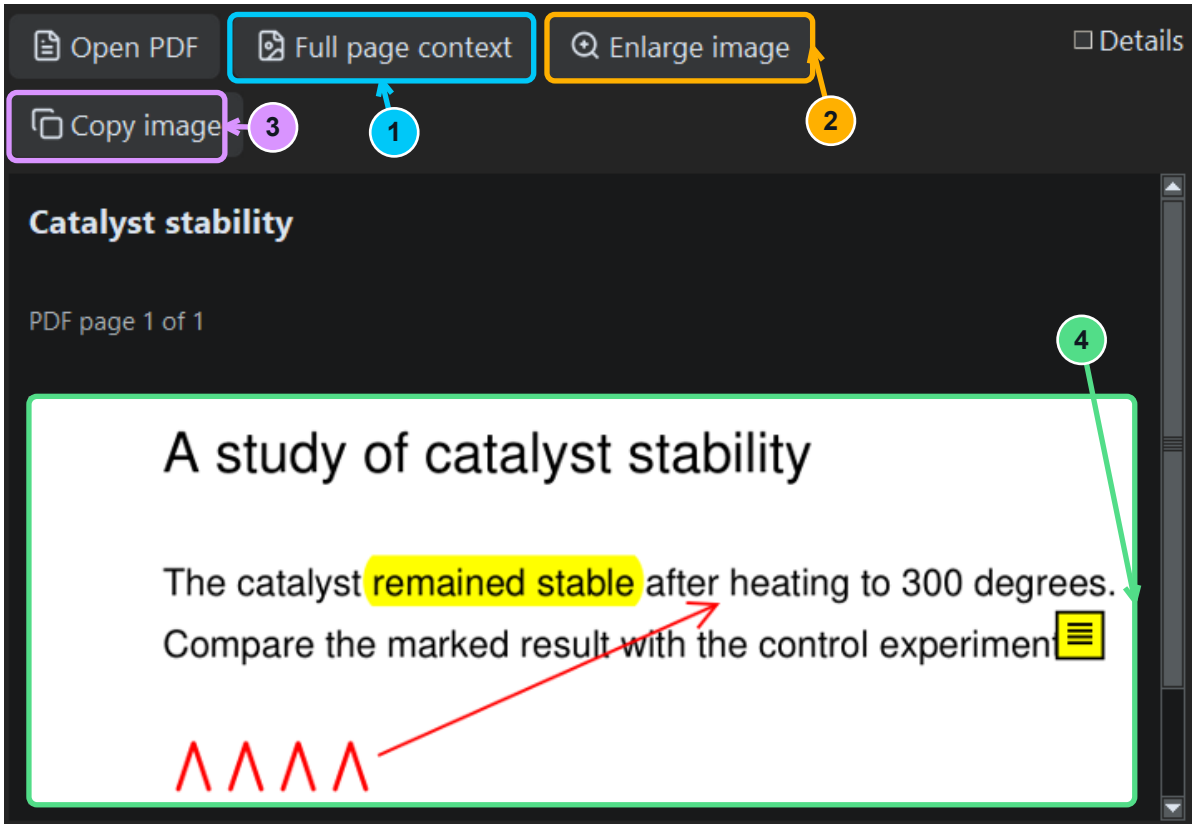
4 **Open the source.** Open PDF, Enter or double-click opens the selected result at its physical PDF page. Full page context previews that page inside Notable.

Page numbers PDF page 3 of 12 means the third physical page in the file. PDF labels and verified journal page numbers appear separately. If your viewer ignores a page jump, navigate to the displayed physical page yourself.

Remember: Details reveals extraction information. Actions → Change history follows the selected note's actual source. Actions → Accessible reading view opens a local browser snapshot.

Inspect a drawing or handwritten note

Use the retained close-up for reading, or open the full page when nearby text, margins or distant marks matter.



1. **Full page context.**
   Opens the complete physical page, including supported margin notes. Its Fit width and Fit height modes follow window resizing.

2. **Enlarge image.**
   Opens the saved close-up at its original resolution. Ctrl + mouse wheel zooms around the pointer; double-click returns to Fit width.

3. **Copy image.**
   Copies the full retained image at original resolution. You can also right-click the image, or focus it and press Ctrl+C. Selected text keeps ordinary copy behavior.

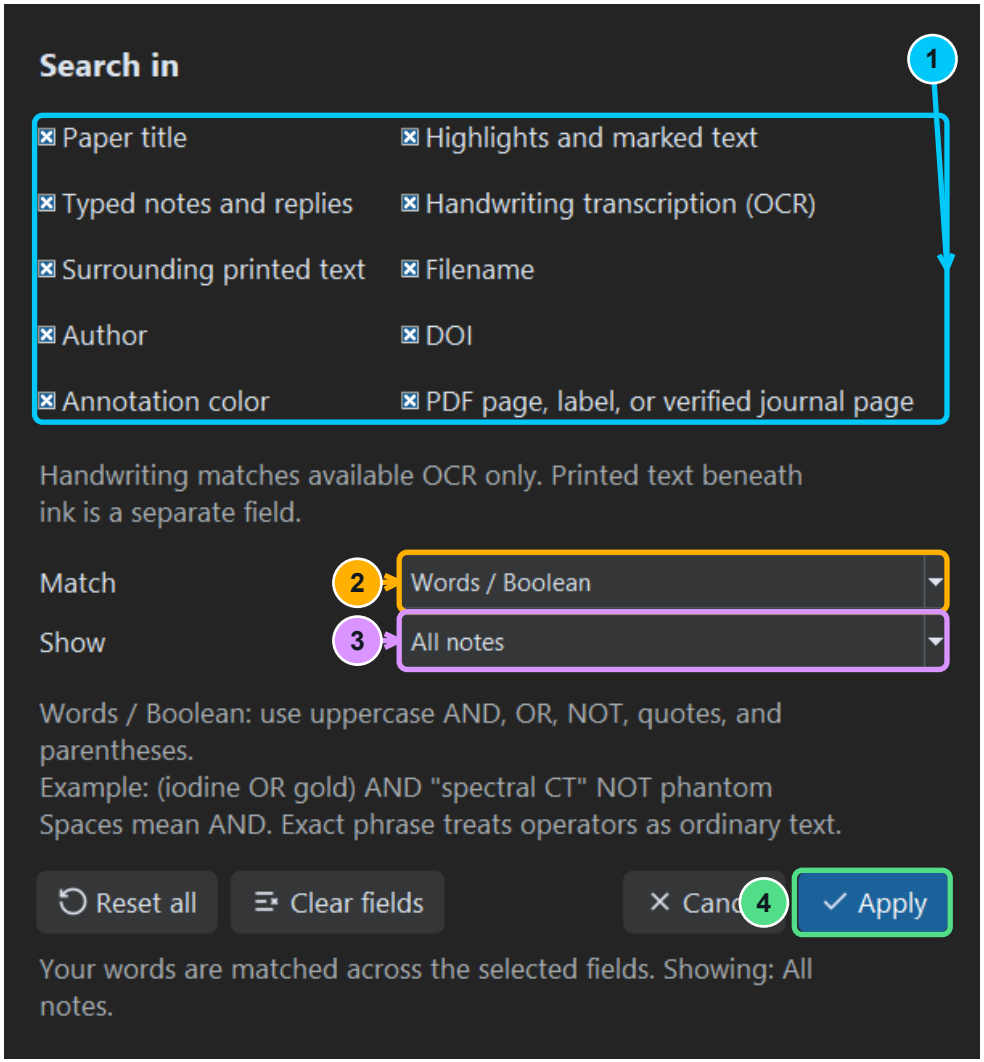
4. **Move around the image.**
   Scroll vertically, drag to pan, and use Shift + mouse wheel horizontally. The normal Notes preview scrolls its text and image together.

When a phrase is split or separate notes are merged Use Library → Folder actions → Folder settings to adjust grouping and context margin, then check a few notes after reprocessing. Automatic grouping estimates which pen strokes belong together.

Remember: Handwriting transcription is optional and may be unavailable. The retained image remains readable without OCR. Source PDFs keep their original page sizes.

Search notes and printed PDF text

Use the Notes search bar. Choose Notes, PDFs or All in the scope selector beside it. Search in controls annotation fields.



1 **Choose the fields.**
Search in can include highlighted text, comments, title, author, DOI, filename, annotation color and available OCR text. These fields apply to note results.

2 **Choose matching.**
Spaces mean AND. Use uppercase AND, OR and NOT, quoted phrases and parentheses in Words / Boolean mode. Example: (catalyst OR enzyme) AND "thermal stability".

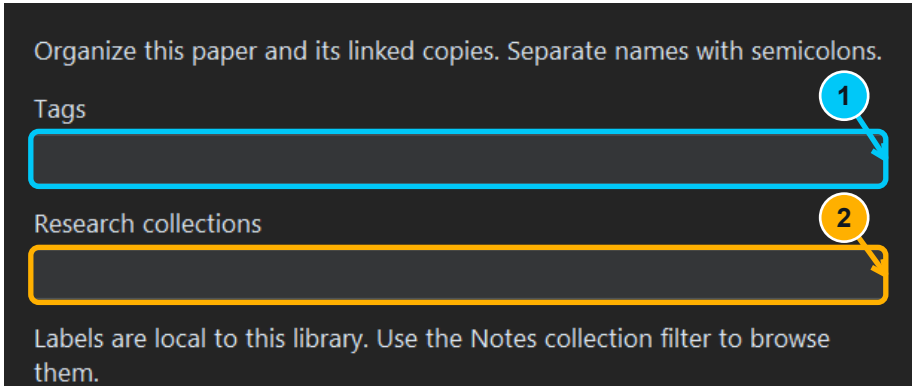
3 **Choose the note type.**
Show narrows annotations by type. In the main scope selector, PDFs searches printed page text, including papers with no notes; All combines both result kinds.

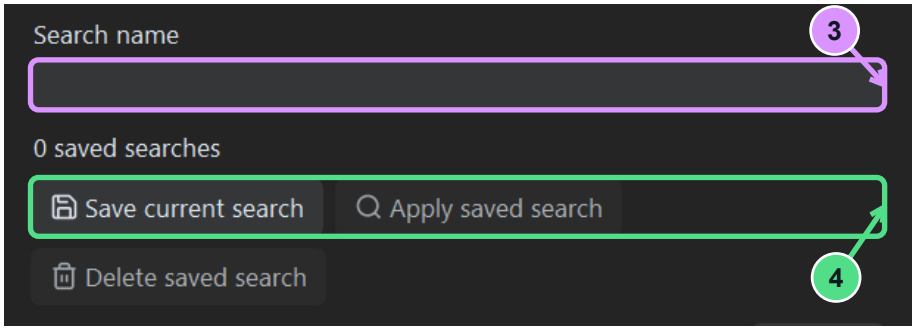
4 **Apply and inspect.**
PDF page matches start with PDF: and show an excerpt. Select a result to read its text, then Open PDF or Full page context for its page.

Remember: Enter a query for PDF text search. First search indexes locally; changed files need Sync PDFs. Image-only scans need a text layer. Export view excludes printed PDF page matches.

Keep searches and organize papers

Use Notes → Actions → Tags & collections or Saved searches. Labels stay in this saved library.





1. **Add tags.**
   Select a specific paper, open Tags & collections, and separate tag names with semicolons. The labels apply to its currently linked copies.

2. **Add research collections.**
   Enter collection names the same way, then save. Use the Collection or tag selector in Notes to browse matching papers and PDF page results.

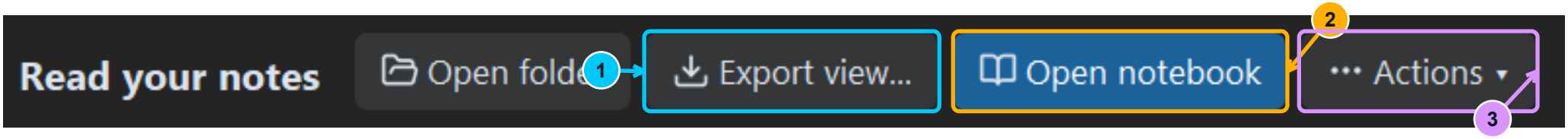
3. **Name the current search.**
   Set the search text, fields, match mode, note type, tag or collection and Notes/PDFs/All scope first. Open Saved searches and enter a useful name.

4. **Save or apply.**
   Save current search keeps those choices. Later, select a saved entry and choose Apply saved search. It applies to your currently selected folder and paper.

Remember: A saved search does not freeze a folder or paper selection. Check the current Notes scope before using a saved search or exporting its results.

Choose the right export

Generated notebooks are refreshed by Notable. Make a separate editable copy for your own research writing.



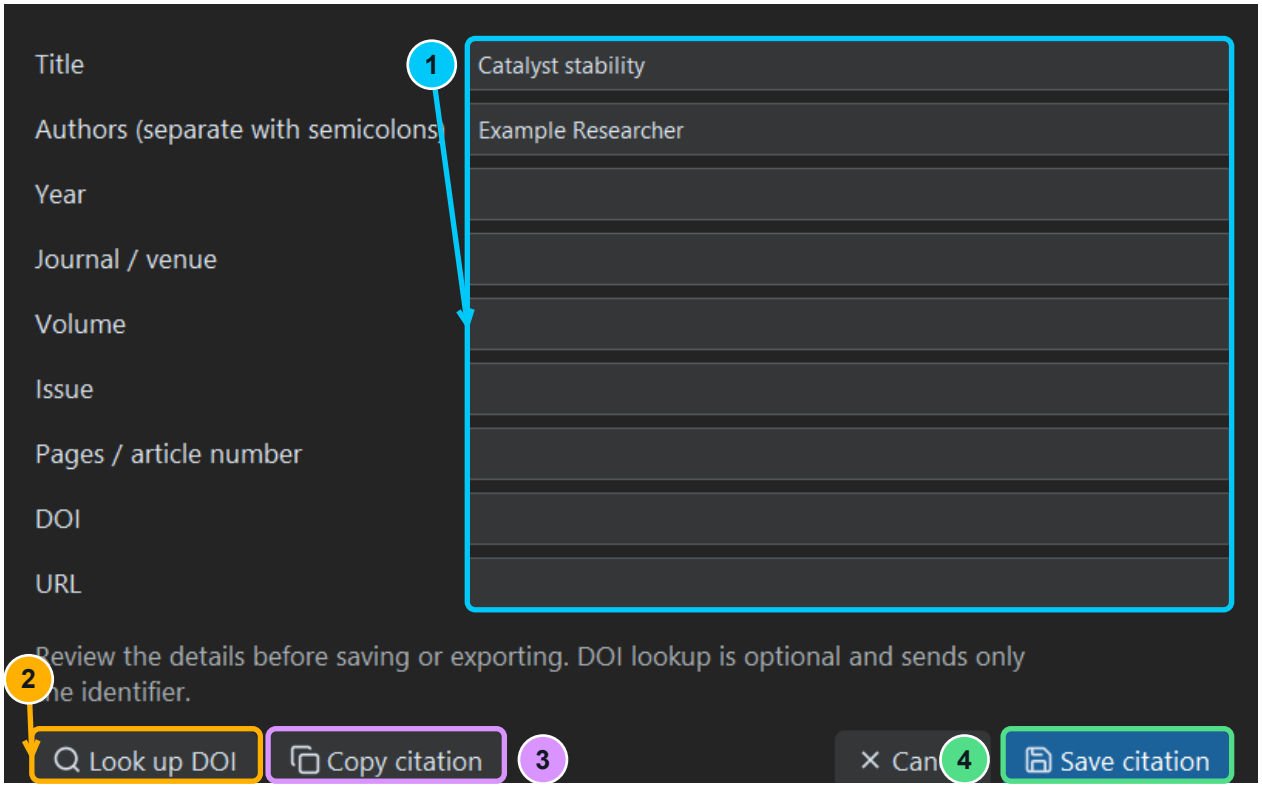
Action	What it produces	Use it when
2 Open notebook	The folder's Notes on <folder>.generated.docx. Reading layout organizes passages under paper and page headings.	You want to read the complete folder notebook.
3 Actions → Save editable copy	A separate Word document that Notable does not regenerate.	You want to add your own writing.
1 Export view	A separate Word notebook containing the currently filtered annotations. Printed PDF text results are excluded.	You want selected notes or a search result.
3 Actions → Export annotated PDF	A lasting separate PDF combining verified PC and tablet marks, including supported margin context.	You want to keep or share the reading PDF.
3 Actions → Export citations	RIS or BibTeX records for the selected paper or current selection scope.	You want to import references into a citation manager.

Refresh the right thing Library → Folder actions → Rebuild notebook regenerates formatting from saved notes. Sync PDFs re-reads changed source content. If you edited a generated notebook, the next replacement preserves it in Notebook backups; it does not merge those edits.

Remember: Continue PC annotation in your original PDF. The combined reading PDF is a temporary app view; export it if you want a lasting copy.

Review citation information

Select a paper in Library or a note in Notes, then choose Actions → Citation details. Review provisional metadata before exporting.



1 **Check and edit the fields.**
Separate authors with semicolons; commas can remain within names. Review year, journal, volume, issue, page range or article number, DOI and URL.

2 **Look up DOI if useful.**
This optional online lookup sends the entered DOI to Crossref/DataCite and fills a draft. Inspect the returned details; lookup does not save automatically.

3 **Copy a reference.**
Copy citation copies the current fields as plain text. It does not apply a particular journal citation style.

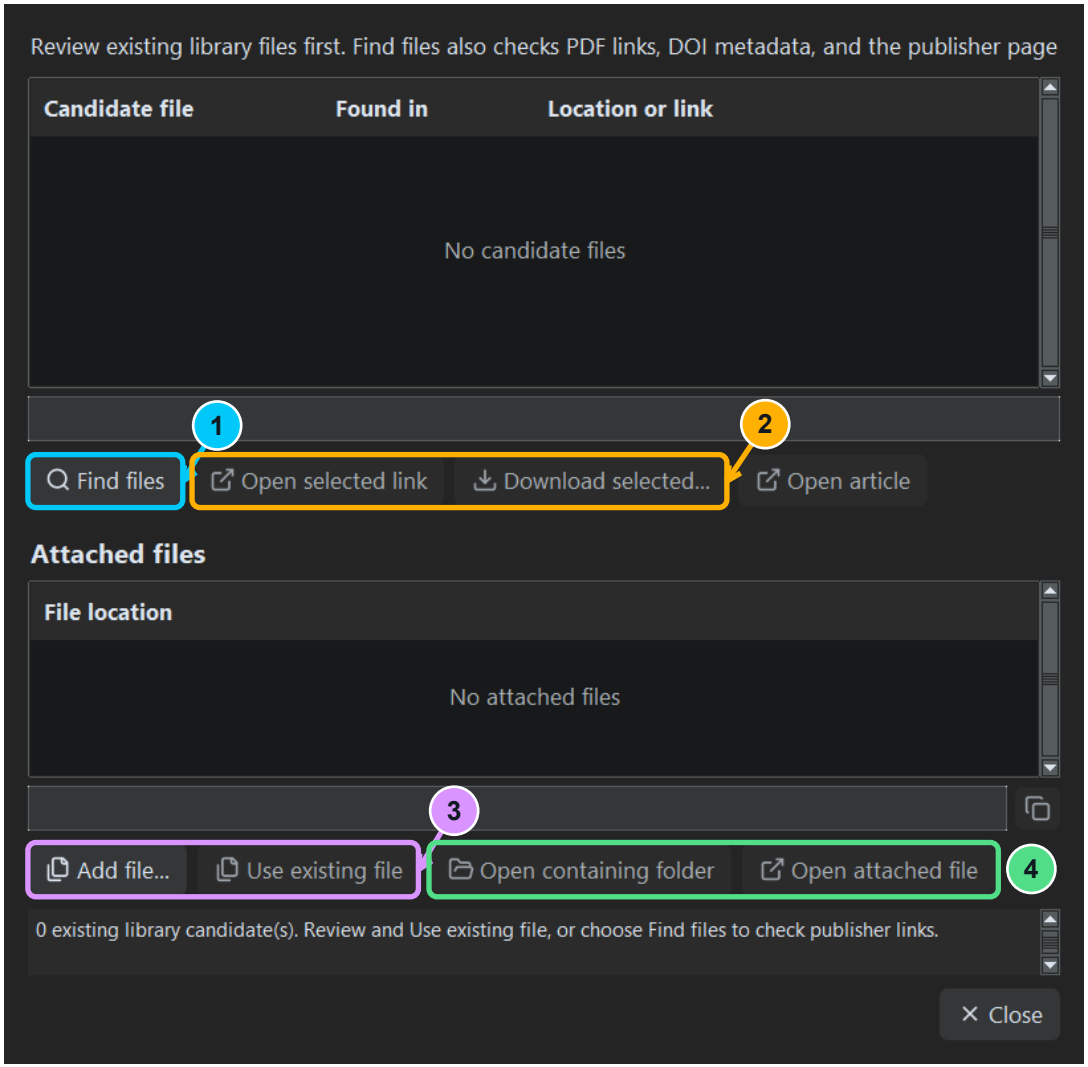
4 **Save citation.**
Saving retains the reviewed details across rescans and shares them with currently linked sources. Cancel discards draft edits.

Export references Choose Actions → Export citations for RIS or BibTeX. Library exports the selected paper, or the selected folder's papers when none is selected. In Notes, a query exports distinct papers in its results; otherwise folder and paper filters determine the set.

Remember: If linked copies have different reviewed citations, choose the citation to keep before linking or exporting. Save a citation draft to apply it.

Attach supplementary files

Select the parent paper, then choose Actions → Find supplementary files. The dialog checks existing local files first.



1. **Find candidates.**
   Find files checks PDF hyperlinks, DOI relationships and public publisher pages. It sends the DOI and requests pages, rather than uploading your PDF or notes.

2. **Inspect before downloading.**
   Select a candidate and read its URL. Open selected link or Open article for a browser check. Download selected saves a reviewed attachment to a new location.

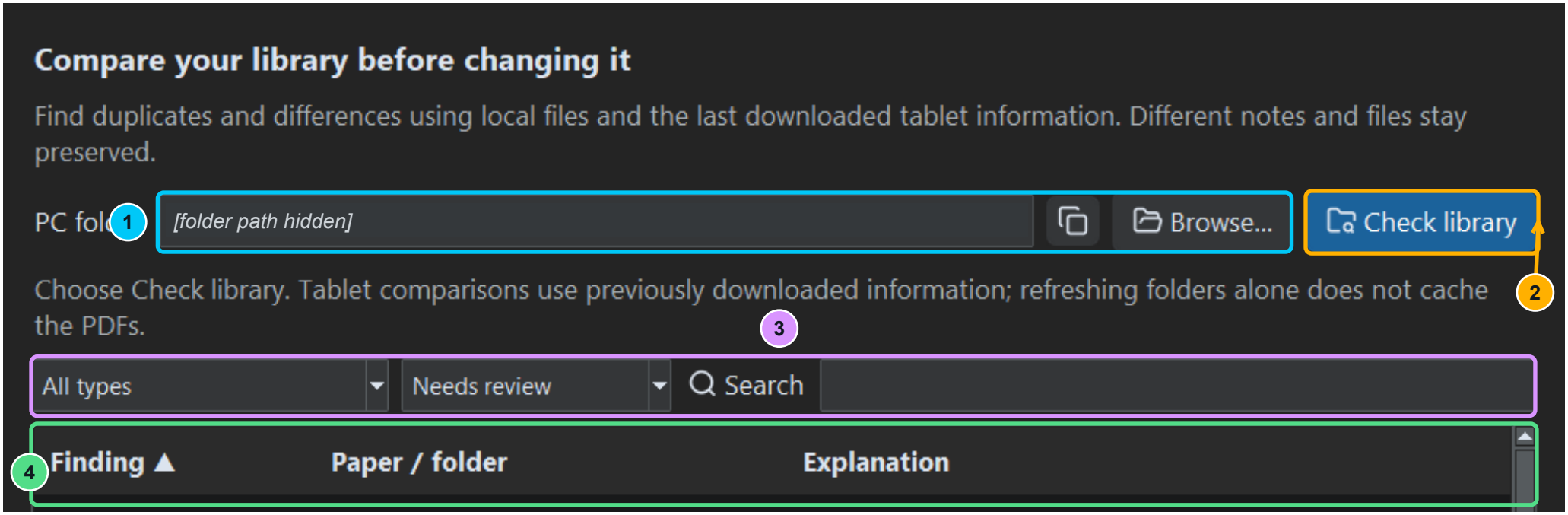
3. **Use an existing file.**
   Select a local candidate and choose Use existing file, or Add file to pick another attachment manually. A similar name alone does not attach or merge files.

4. **Open an attachment.**
   Choose a saved attachment, then Open attached file or Open containing folder. Supplementary information stays separate from its parent paper.

Remember: If publisher discovery cannot access a file, download it in your browser and attach it manually. Existing files are not overwritten; supported downloads are limited to 100 MB.

Review possible duplicate papers

Open Review library from Inbox or Library. Start with a small folder and inspect the actual PDFs before linking copies.



1 **Choose the area.** Browse to the PC folder you want to inspect. Tablet comparison uses previously downloaded information; a folder refresh alone does not download PDF annotations.

2 **Check library.** This check finds suggestions using local information. It does not move, delete, upload or link files. The example list has not been populated yet.

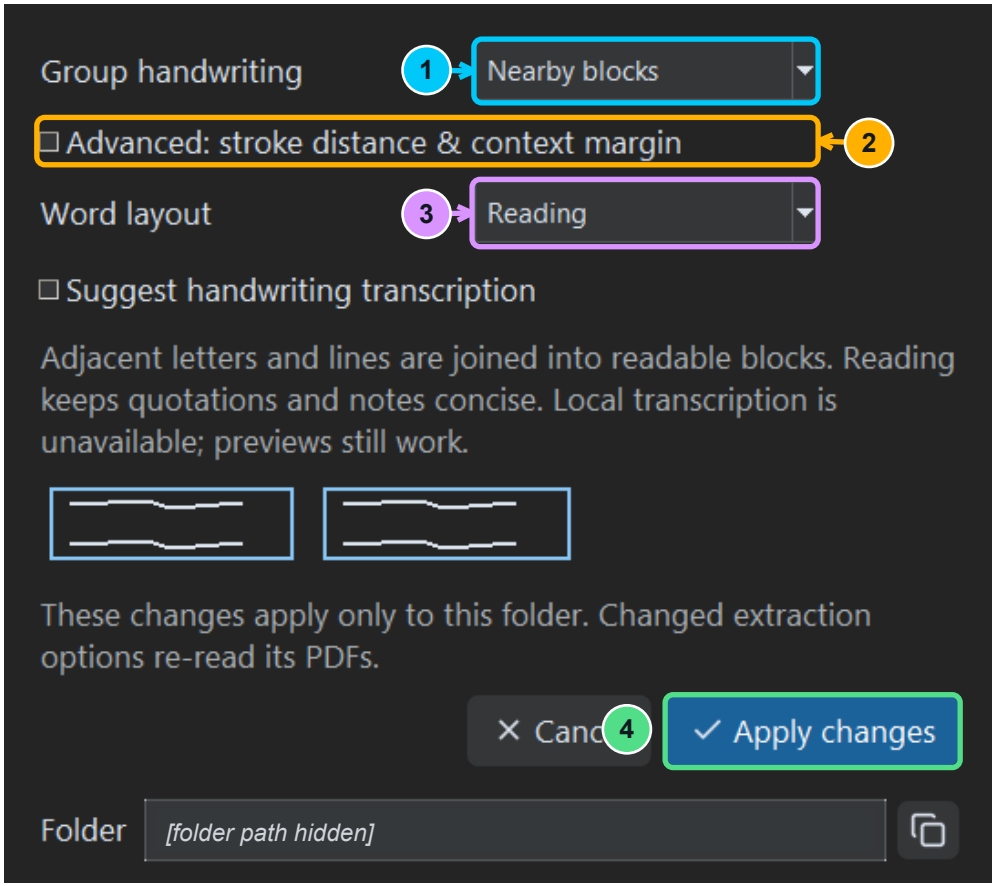
3 **Filter and inspect.** Use the finding type, review state and Search box. Select a finding, read the details below, and open its source PDFs and containing folders.

4 **Choose the relationship.** Link selected copies only for the same paper. Keep separate records a different edition or independent item. Supplementary files stay separate.

Remember: Linking combines paper entries and notebook headings, retaining files, history and independent notes. Undo last link restores the latest supported relationship change; it does not undo file operations.

Adjust viewing and handwriting settings

Settings → Preferences controls the viewer and defaults for newly added folders. Existing folders keep their own Folder settings.



1 **Choose grouping.**
Nearby blocks usually joins letters and lines into readable notes. Nearby lines joins less vertically. Whole page keeps distant marks together, useful for connected diagrams.

2 **Adjust advanced distances.**
Increase joining distance for split phrases; decrease it when independent notes merge. A larger context margin shows more surroundings. Check a small sample afterward.

3 **Choose a Word layout.**
Reading keeps quotations and comments concise. Detailed includes more extraction information. Handwriting transcription is optional, off by default, and needs Tesseract on PATH.

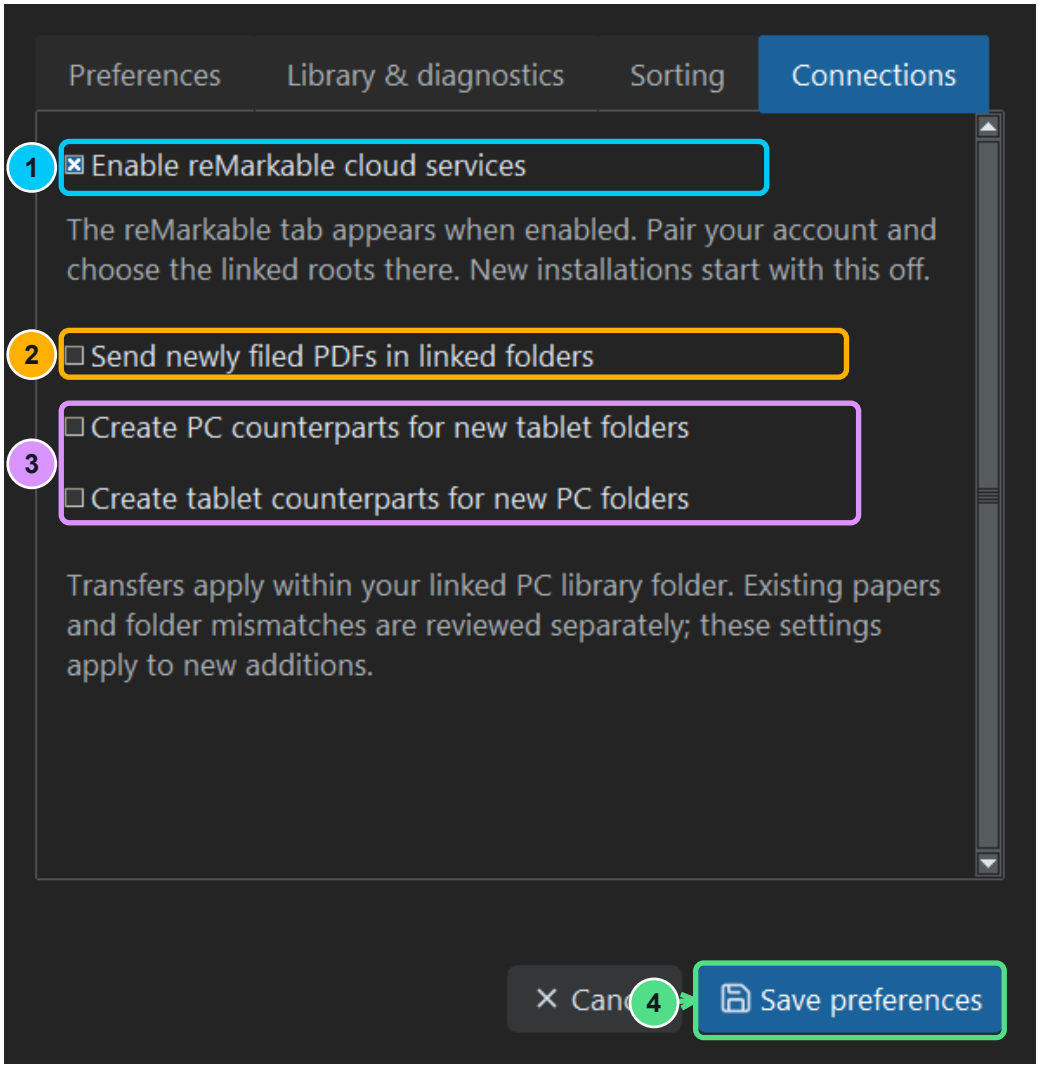
4 **Apply this folder's changes.**
Changed extraction options re-read that folder's PDFs. To set defaults for future folders, use Preferences instead.

Choose the PDF viewer In Preferences, Windows default uses your registered application. Recognized options include Edge, Chrome, Firefox, Acrobat/Reader and SumatraPDF; Other application lets you choose an executable. Saving this preference does not change Windows file associations.

Remember: Some default or custom viewers ignore page parameters. Use the physical PDF page number shown in Notable when you navigate manually.

Enable optional tablet features

PC-only reading and sorting work without a reMarkable connection. Cloud services start off in a new library.



1. **Enable cloud services.**
   Open Settings → Connections, enable the master switch and save. This reveals the reMarkable tab. Turning the switch off hides it and pauses cloud work while retaining saved material.

2. **Allow sending if wanted.**
   Send newly filed PDFs in linked folders permits outgoing work for newly filed PDFs inside the linked PC root. Existing papers are not bulk uploaded on launch.

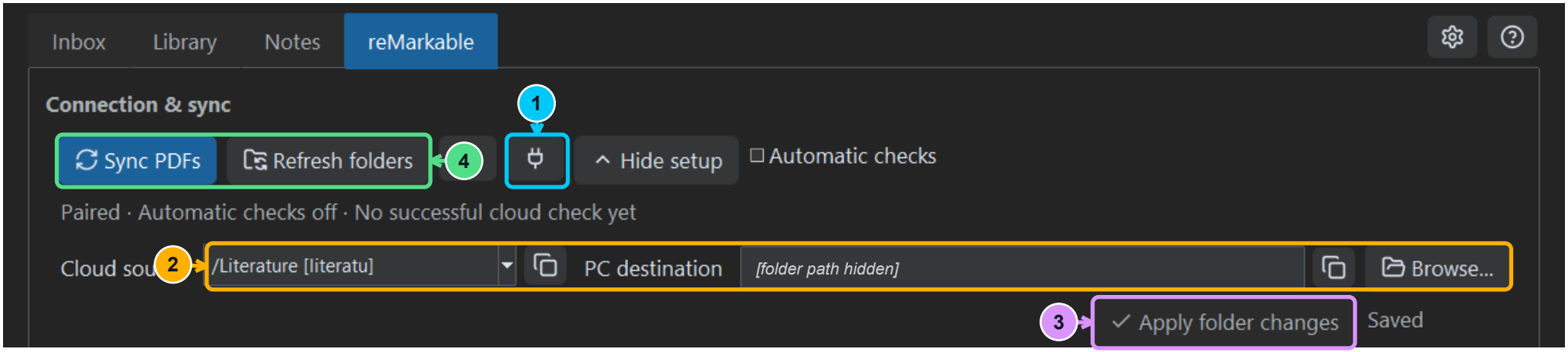
3. **Choose folder creation separately.**
   PC counterparts for new tablet folders and tablet counterparts for new PC folders are independent permissions. Existing mismatches still need review and mapping.

4. **Save preferences.**
   All Settings tabs save together. Start with outgoing sending and folder creation off while you verify the selected source, destination and first few papers.

Remember: The integration handles imported PDFs and their tablet annotations. Native reMarkable notebooks and EPUBs are skipped. Check a small real-device sample before relying on a large sync.

Pair and choose the tablet scope

In reMarkable, use the plug Connection menu to connect. Pairing uses a single-use code from the reMarkable pairing page.



1 **Pair the account.** Choose Connect reMarkable, open the pairing page and sign in there. Enter the eight-character single-use code in Notable; do not enter your account password into the app.

2 **Choose both ends.** Expand Edit setup. Pick the exact Cloud source and an existing PC destination. Only that cloud folder and its descendants are in scope.

3 **Apply folder changes.** Save the source/root draft. When edits are pending, Apply & sync PDFs saves them before checking. A blank source never silently selects the entire tablet.

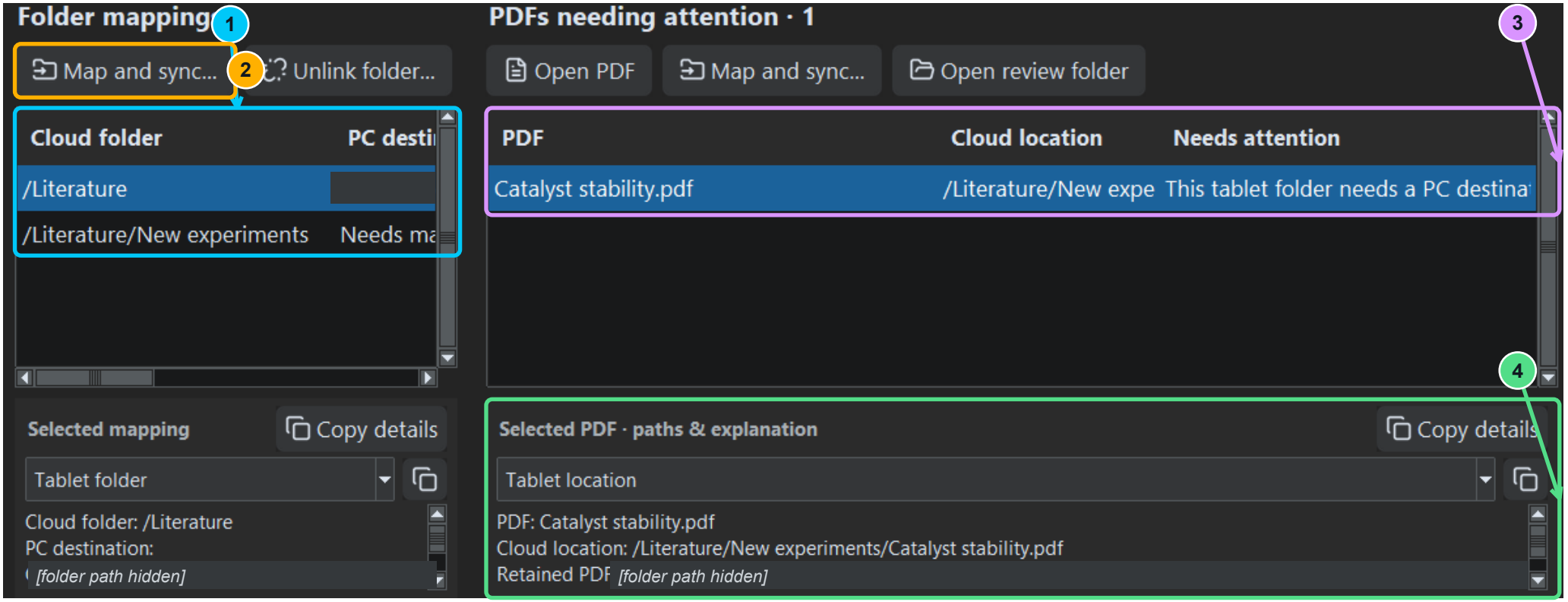
4 **Check deliberately.** Refresh folders loads the cloud folder catalog. Sync PDFs downloads changed supported PDFs and annotations, and processes separately enabled outgoing queues.

Automatic checks The checkbox in the tab applies immediately and checks every five minutes while the app is open. It is separate from source/root edits and the sending permissions in Connections. Tablet annotations arrive after the tablet uploads its changes over Wi-Fi.

Remember: The pictured account is an offline example. Pairing and cloud operations depend on your account, connectivity and supported tablet document format.

Resolve folder mappings and review items

A tablet folder can map to a differently named PC folder beneath the linked root. Read the full explanation before syncing.



1. **Select the folder.** Needs mapping means routing needs a PC destination. Choose the existing counterpart within your linked root; the folder names may differ.

2. **Map and sync.** Inspect both locations before confirming. This saves the mapping and starts a sync, which can also process outgoing work if its permissions are enabled.

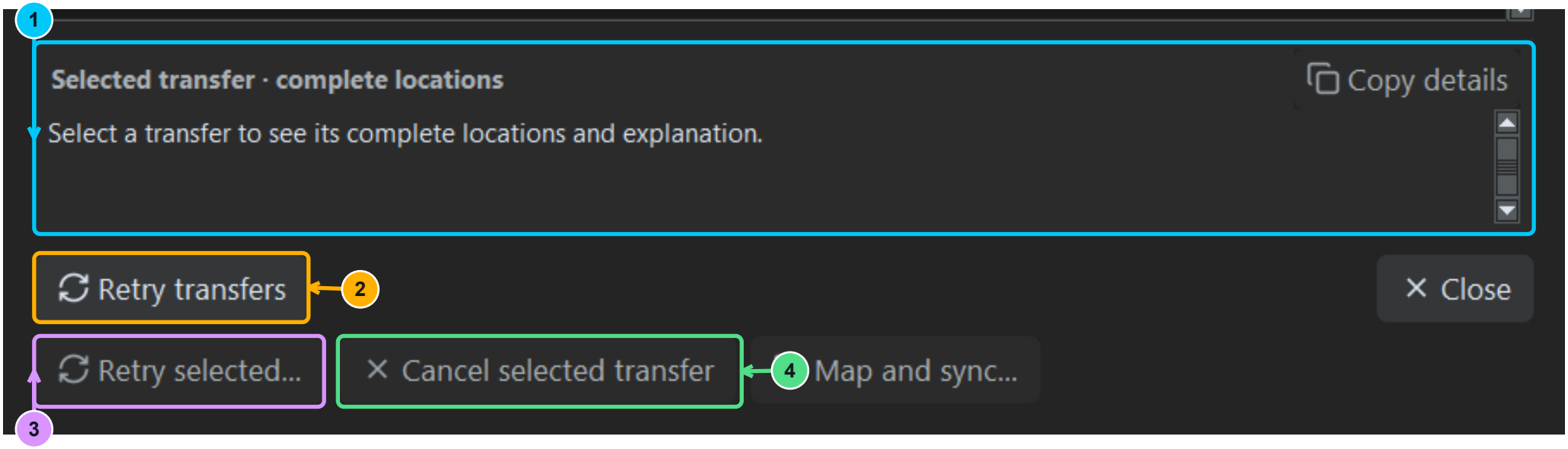
3. **Select a PDF needing attention.** Read its reason. Open PDF opens a retained review PDF when available; Open review folder lets you inspect saved material.

4. **Read the paths and details.** The lower panel shows the retained PDF and proposed destination. Copy details keeps the explanation and complete paths together.

Remember: Unlinking a descendant returns it to source-path matching. Unlinking the main source clears its PC destination and disables automatic checks. Existing PDFs and notes remain.

Review outgoing transfers

Open the list icon for Transfer queue on the reMarkable tab. Local filing can finish while cloud work is offline.



1 **Inspect the selected job.** Select an unfinished transfer in the list above this crop. Read its status, source file, destination and complete explanation in the details panel.

2 **Retry eligible work.** Retry transfers processes jobs currently able to run. Restore unavailable local sources and resolve Needs mapping first.

3 **Confirm a changed job.** Retry selected asks you to accept its current file and linked destination. Read these carefully if the PDF, root, source or route changed after queuing.

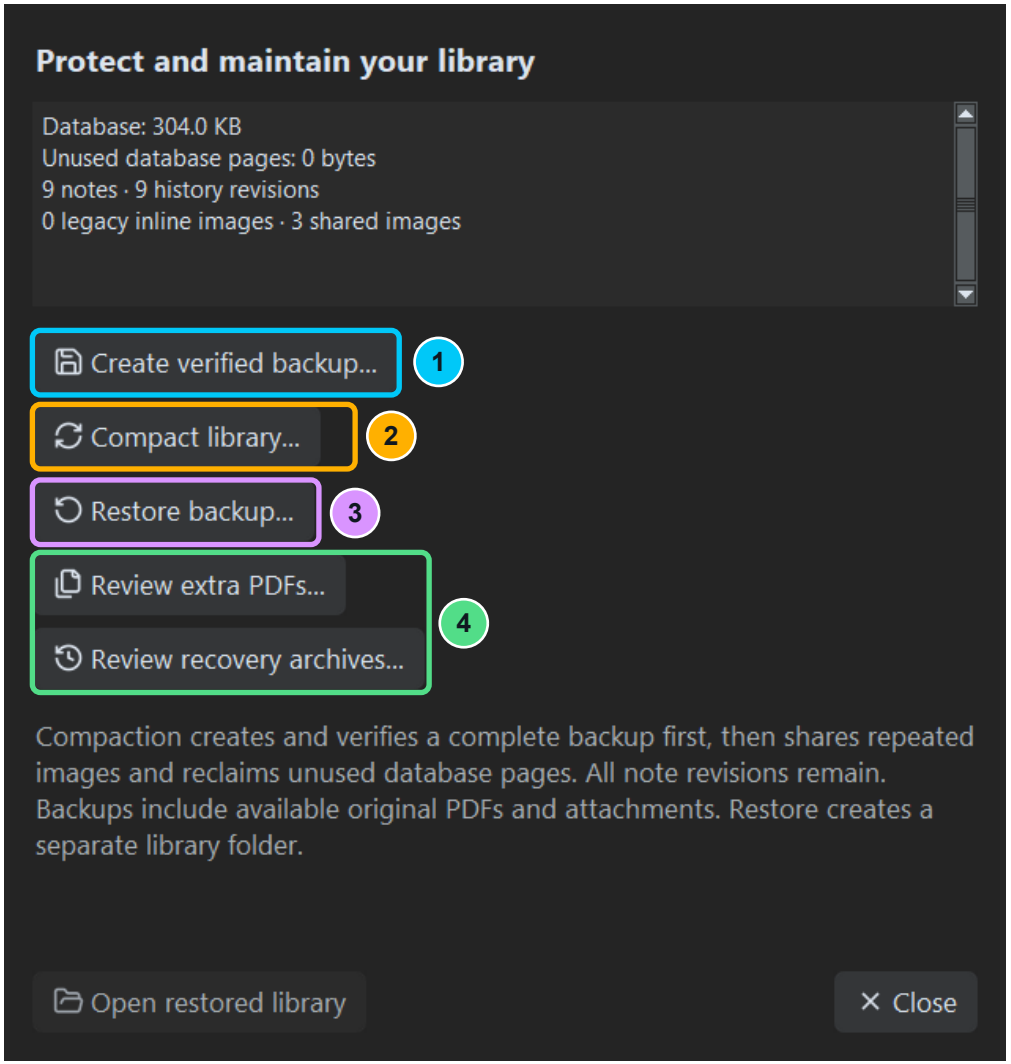
4 **Cancel future work.** Cancel selected transfer stops an unfinished job. It does not delete the PC file or a cloud item that may already have been committed.

Queue states Needs mapping requires a route. Review requires reading the explanation and confirming the next step. Retryable failures can be retried after their cause is resolved. Completed transfers are already sent; cancellation is not a way to undo them.

Remember: The example queue is empty, so selected-job commands are disabled. Folder creation and PDF sending both appear in this queue.

Back up and maintain the library

Open Library → Actions → Library storage & backups, or use the button in Settings → Library & diagnostics.



1. **Create a verified backup.**
   Save the hash-verified ZIP to a safe location and keep another copy on separate storage. It includes the database, settings, retained tablet sources and available originals and attachments.

2. **Compact explicitly.**
   Compaction creates and verifies a backup first, shares repeated images and reclaims unused database pages. Annotation revisions remain saved.

3. **Restore separately.**
   Restore backup verifies the ZIP and creates a new independent directory. Open restored library launches it. Review setup first; Inbox watching and cloud services start paused.

4. **Review cleanup candidates.**
   Review extra PDFs and Review recovery archives explain which old app material is proven redundant. Read every reason and backup requirement before removing selected items.

Remember: Unavailable external files cannot be included. Keep separate backups of your actual paper folders, personal Word documents and Notebook backups. Pairing or API keys may need re-entry under another Windows account.

Troubleshoot everyday problems

Use the local checks below before changing folders or replacing files. Saved notes remain available when a source is temporarily missing.

What you see	What to do
The wrong folders or account appeared	Open Settings → Library & diagnostics and check Active library. Source and older packaged versions can use different data directories. Diagnostics does not merge them.
An Inbox file stays Waiting	Finish the download, wait for the file to stop changing and refresh again. Use a supported file directly inside the incoming folder. Review again if its contents changed.
A watched folder is unavailable	Reconnect its drive. If you moved the collection, use Library → Folder actions → Locate moved folder on the existing entry. Avoid removing and re-adding it when you want to keep history.
A PDF failed to read	Open Show sync details or the footer's View sync details. Restore a missing source or close an application holding it, then Sync PDFs. A failed scan keeps the last successful notes.
Handwriting looks split or merged	Inspect Open PDF and Full page context. Adjust grouping or context margin in that folder's settings, reprocess and check a small sample.
Printed text search misses a paper	Use PDFs or All scope with a query. Sync changed files first. Image-only scans need a searchable text layer; PDF search does not run whole-document OCR.
Open PDF goes to the wrong page	Use the physical PDF page shown by Notable. Choose a recognized viewer in Preferences; some default or custom viewers ignore page-jump parameters.

Remember: Flattened marks are part of the page image/content and cannot reliably be separated into annotations. Inspect the source when extraction differs from what you see.

Troubleshoot syncing and recovery

Read the full status and saved paths before retrying a transfer or choosing between retained file copies.

What you see	What to do
The generated notebook has not updated	Close it in Word and read Library’s sync log. Locked exports remain pending and normally retry every 30 seconds. Rebuild notebook changes formatting from saved notes; Sync PDFs refreshes extraction.
The notebook lost edits you made directly	Look in the adjacent Notebook backups folder. Preserved edits are not merged into regenerated notebooks. Use Save editable copy for ongoing personal writing.
A tablet paper is missing or Needs mapping	Check the master switch, pairing, exact cloud source, available PC root and folder mapping. Let the tablet upload over Wi-Fi, then Sync PDFs. Refresh folders alone does not download annotations.
An upload is held for review	Open Transfer queue, inspect the source and destination, and resolve missing files or mapping first. Retry selected confirms current contents and routing; cancellation only stops future work.
A previous PDF copy is retained	Use View sync details to find its complete .preserved path. Compare the current file with the retained previous copy. A recovery notice can remain even when the new PDF saved successfully.
Save preferences failed	The dialog stays open and previous saved choices/key remain. Correct the draft or Cancel. If settings saved but automatic checks could not restart, use manual Inbox refresh and investigate that separate error.

What to keep Your originals, retained tablet baselines/layers, database history and explicit exports serve different purposes. Temporary download and reading caches have budgets; those budgets are not limits on the entire saved library.

Remember: Reconstructing a combined reading view does not rewrite your PC original or add PC marks to the existing tablet document.

Keyboard and mouse reference

These shortcuts complement the visible buttons. Keep the relevant workspace or image pane active.

Shortcut or gesture	Action
Alt+1 / Alt+2 / Alt+3	Switch to Inbox / Library / Notes.
Ctrl+F	Focus note search.
F5	Sync local PDFs. In VS Code, F5 starts the selected debug profile.
Ctrl+,	Open Settings.
Ctrl+Shift+S	Open Saved searches.
Ctrl+Shift+T	Open Tags & collections.
Ctrl+Shift+A	Open the accessible reading view of current results.
Enter or double-click a note/PDF result	Open its PDF at the physical source page.
Right-click / Shift+F10 / Menu key	Open the watched-folder context menu when a folder is selected.
Escape	Use a dialog’s Cancel or Close action. Unsaved Settings drafts are discarded.
Ctrl + mouse wheel in an image window	Zoom around the pointer. Double-click restores Fit width.
Shift + mouse wheel / drag an image	Pan horizontally / pan by dragging.
Drag / double-click a column divider	Resize a table column / fit its current rows.
Tab then Space or Enter on a path copy button	Copy the complete selected path.

Guide reference Prepared for the local Notable 2.5.0 source interface on October 13, 2026. Procedures were checked against the project README and current interface definitions; screenshots are from the same-day offline example audit. Consult in-app Help and the project README for later changes and initial dependency installation.